

DOING THE RIDICULOUS RECEIVING THE MIRACULOUS

TEXT: 1 Kings 17

INTRO: (Relate story of Elijah prophesying a 3 ½ year drought to Ahab... God gave Elijah water by the brook Cherith and sent ravens with bread and flesh in the morning and in the evening... In the course of time the brook dried up... God sent Elijah to Zarephath and there he engages in a

conversation with a widow who was financially destitute...)

I. RIDICULOUS REQUESTS...

Notice verses 10-13 (NKJV)

“So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, indeed a widow was there gathering sticks. And he called to her and said, “Please bring me a little water in a cup, that I may drink.”¹¹ And as she was going to get it, he called to her and said, “Please bring me a morsel of bread in your hand.”¹² So she said, “As the Lord your God lives, I do not have

bread, only a handful of flour in a bin, and a little oil in a jar; and see, I am gathering a couple of sticks that I may go in and prepare it for myself and my son, that we may eat it, and die.”¹³ And Elijah said to her, “Do not fear; go and do as you have said, but make me a small cake from it first, and bring it to me; and afterward make some for yourself and your son.”

The Prophet Elijah does something here that I find to be over the top; out of bounds; even bordering on being ridiculous; he asks a widow

who has just enough meal and
oil left for some bread for she
and her son, to make him a cake
FIRST!

There are times in our lives
when the path to healing, help
and prosperity is purposely
planned through ridiculous
territory!

- Abraham (Go, but not told where)
- Moses (Take off your shoes)
- David (Fight a giant with a slingshot)

- Three Hebrew Children
(Do not bow)
- Paul (Lay your life down
for the sake of the Gospel)

Ridiculous request's lead to
ridiculous faith! 1 Kings 17:14
(NKJV) *“For thus says
the Lord God of Israel: ‘The
bin of flour shall not be used
up, nor shall the jar of oil run
dry, until the day the Lord
sends rain on the earth.’ ”*

What ridiculous thing is God
saying to you today?

**II. RIDICULOUS
ACTIONS...**

One would think this lady
would tell the man of God to
get lost! This appears to be
another greedy preacher
looking for a hand-out! (I hate
it when preachers ask for
ministerial discounts!)

1 Kings 17:15 (NKJV) “***So she
went away and did according
to the word of Elijah.***” This
lady never so much as
questioned the words of Elijah.
She just took what seemed to be
a ridiculous action!

Ridiculous actions lead on to
ridiculous faith! Hebrews 11:6

(NKJV) *“Without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.”*

If we need a ridiculous blessing, we may be called upon to take a ridiculous action!

III. MIRACULOUS RESULTS...

1 Kings 17:15-16 (NKJV) *“So she went away and did according to the word of Elijah; and she and he and her*

household ate for many days.

¹⁶ The bin of flour was not used up, nor did the jar of oil run dry, according to the word of the Lord which He spoke by Elijah.”

We are not told exactly how much time went by between the time this widow made a cake for the man of God, believing she and her son would be taken care of, the Bible just say’s “*She and her son did eat many days.*”

What we are sure of is that the drought lasted 3 ½ years! It is possible the meal and oil lasted for a thousand days or more!

The oil and meal did not grow,
it just stayed!

Sometimes God does not
choose to allow us to see the
reserves; He just allows us to
see the bare minimum and asks
us to trust Him, believing there
is more than enough!

When we step out in obedient
faith to do the ridiculous, God
has obligated himself to do the
miraculous!

Those who need the miraculous
will probably be required to set
the miracle in motion by doing
the ridiculous!

When this lady stepped out in obedient faith, doing the ridiculous, she set in motion the miraculous for her and her family!

1 Kings 17:17-24 (NKJV)

“Now it happened after these things that the son of the woman who owned the house became sick. And his sickness was so serious that there was no breath left in him. ¹⁸ So she said to Elijah, “What have I to do with you, O man of God? Have you come to me to bring my sin to remembrance, and to

kill my son?”¹⁹ And he said to her, “Give me your son.” So he took him out of her arms and carried him to the upper room where he was staying, and laid him on his own bed.²⁰ Then he cried out to the Lord and said, “O Lord my God, have You also brought tragedy on the widow with whom I lodge, by killing her son?”²¹ And he stretched himself out on the child three times, and cried out to the Lord and said, “O Lord my God, I pray, let this child’s soul come back to him.”²² Then the Lord heard the voice

of Elijah; and the soul of the child came back to him, and he revived. ²³ And Elijah took the child and brought him down from the upper room into the house, and gave him to his mother. And Elijah said, “See, your son lives!” ²⁴ Then the woman said to Elijah, “Now by this I know that you are a man of God, and that the word of the Lord in your mouth is the truth.”

If this woman had not trusted the man of God with the little things, she could never have

trusted him for her son! The miracle of the meal and oil was just a starter miracle for what would follow!

What is God getting us ready for? Are we going to pass or fail the present test? If we fail this test, it will set us up for defeat at a later time! If we pass this test, we will be placing ourselves and our families in the pathway of a blessing at a more crucial time!

CONCLUSION:

If we need the miraculous, we

must be willing to do the
ridiculous!

- If we need a financial miracle, we must give a ridiculous offering...
- If we need a miracle of healing, we must trust God in a ridiculous way... (Pray for someone else)
- If we need a relational miracle, we must humble ourselves before man, taking the high road of humility...

- If we need a spiritual miracle, we must find a place to serve others...
- If we need a miracle of cooperation, we must submit ourselves to those who have authority over us...